PES UNIVERSITY

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100ft Ring Road, BSK 3rd Stage,

Bangalore-560085

“PERCEIVED DIFFERENTIATION BETWEEN BLINKIT AND INSTAMART IN CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE”

MBA PROGRAM

RESEARCH-BASED PROJECT

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SUBMITTED BY: PRAJWAL SV (PES1PG25MB173)
MBA TRIMESTER-I - “E SECTION”
SUBMITTED TO: PROF. KEERTHI VARMA
PES UNIVERSITY

Perceived Differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart in Customer Experience.

ABSTRACT

The rapid growth of quick commerce (Q-commerce) platforms in India has intensified competition among major players such as Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart, making customer experience a critical source of differentiation. While prior research has extensively examined delivery speed, pricing, and operational efficiency as key drivers of customer satisfaction in Q-commerce, relatively limited attention has been given to the role of app usability in shaping customers' perceived differentiation between competing platforms. This study addresses this gap by examining how app usability influences perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart from the customer's perspective.

The study adopts a quantitative research design using primary data collected through a structured online survey. A total of 196 valid responses were obtained from users who had experience using either or both platforms. The survey measured key customer experience dimensions, including app navigation and ordering ease, delivery experience, product availability, customer support responsiveness, and overall perceived differentiation between the two platforms. Descriptive statistics and correlation analysis were employed to examine relationships among variables, with a specific focus on Hypothesis: App usability positively influences perceived differentiation.

The findings reveal that customers perceive only a moderate overall differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart; however, app usability emerges as the strongest predictor of perceived differentiation among all experience dimensions examined. The correlation analysis indicates that ease of navigation, clarity of interface, and smooth ordering flow have a stronger association with perceived differentiation than delivery speed or customer support responsiveness. This suggests that while operational factors remain important, the digital interface acts as a key psychological touchpoint through which customers evaluate and compare competing Q-commerce platforms. Customers are more likely to perceive platforms as distinct when one offers a simpler, faster, and more intuitive app experience.

The study contributes to Q-commerce literature by empirically highlighting app usability as a strategic differentiation lever rather than merely a functional requirement. From a managerial perspective, the results suggest that investments in user interface design, seamless checkout processes, and frictionless navigation can enhance perceived differentiation and strengthen customer preference in an otherwise homogeneous market. The findings underscore the need for Q-commerce firms to balance operational efficiency with superior digital experience to achieve sustainable competitive advantage.

Keywords: *Quick Commerce (Q-commerce), App Usability, Perceived Differentiation, Customer Experience, Platform Loyalty*

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INTRODUCTION

The rapid advancement of digital technologies and changing urban lifestyles have significantly transformed the retail landscape in India. One of the most prominent outcomes of this transformation is the emergence of Quick Commerce (Q-commerce)—a business model designed to deliver daily essentials such as groceries, personal care items, and household products within extremely short timeframes, often ranging from 10 to 30 minutes. Unlike traditional e-commerce, which prioritizes assortment and price competitiveness, Q-commerce is built around immediacy, convenience, and seamless digital interaction. As Indian consumers increasingly value time efficiency and instant gratification, Q-commerce platforms have become an integral part of urban consumption behavior.

In India's Q-commerce ecosystem, platforms such as Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart have emerged as dominant players. Both platforms operate on similar hyperlocal delivery models supported by dark stores, real-time inventory management, and last-mile logistics optimization. They target comparable customer segments, particularly urban professionals, students, and nuclear households seeking fast access to daily essentials. While these platforms appear operationally similar, competition in the Q-commerce sector has intensified to a point where functional parity is increasingly common. As a result, firms are compelled to differentiate themselves not only through speed and pricing but also through the quality of the customer experience, particularly through the digital interface.

Customer experience has emerged as a central determinant of competitive advantage in digital platform markets. In Q-commerce, customer experience is multidimensional, encompassing delivery speed, order accuracy, product availability, customer support, refund processes, and digital interaction quality. Among these dimensions, the mobile application interface plays a pivotal role, as it represents the primary touchpoint between the customer and the service provider. The app is not merely a transactional tool but an experience environment where customers browse products, place orders, track deliveries, and resolve issues.

Despite the operational emphasis traditionally placed on logistics and delivery speed, recent shifts in consumer expectations suggest that app usability has become increasingly important in

shaping customer perceptions. App usability refers to the ease with which users can navigate the platform, search for products, understand information, and complete transactions with minimal effort. Features such as intuitive navigation, clear categorization, fast loading times, and simplified checkout processes significantly influence how customers evaluate a platform.

In highly competitive digital markets, perceived differentiation does not arise solely from objective service differences but from how customers perceive and interpret their interactions with competing platforms. When platforms offer similar products at comparable prices with similar delivery timelines, subtle differences in digital experience can meaningfully influence customer preferences, satisfaction, and loyalty. This phenomenon is particularly relevant in Q-commerce, where switching costs are low, and customers frequently use multiple platforms depending on context or offers.

Existing literature on Q-commerce has largely focused on operational efficiency, delivery speed, pricing strategies, and infrastructure optimization. While these factors are critical, fewer empirical studies have examined how app usability influences perceived differentiation between competing Q-commerce platforms, particularly from the customer's subjective perspective. This creates a research gap, especially in the Indian context, where digital adoption is high, but user expectations and digital literacy levels vary.

Against this backdrop, the present study investigates perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart, with a specific focus on app usability as a key driver of differentiation. Using primary data collected through a structured customer survey, the study examines how users evaluate app usability and how these evaluations relate to their overall perception of differentiation between the two platforms.

The relevance of this research is both academic and managerial. Academically, the study contributes to digital customer experience literature by highlighting app usability as a strategic differentiation variable within Q-commerce. Managerially, the findings offer actionable insights for Q-commerce firms seeking sustainable competitive advantage in a saturated market, emphasizing the need to balance operational efficiency with superior digital experience.

In summary, this study is situated at the intersection of digital customer experience and competitive strategy within the Indian Q-commerce sector. By focusing on app usability as a determinant of perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart, the research provides a focused foundation for empirically testing Hypothesis, which proposes that app usability positively influences perceived differentiation.

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LITERATURE REVIEW

Quick Commerce (Q-commerce) has emerged as a transformative model within the digital retail ecosystem, reshaping consumer purchasing behavior through ultra-fast delivery of daily essentials. Unlike traditional e-commerce, which emphasizes broad assortments and cost efficiency, Q-commerce is fundamentally designed around immediacy, convenience, and continuous digital interaction. The growth of this model in India has been driven by rapid urbanization, increased smartphone penetration, evolving consumer lifestyles, and heightened expectations for speed and ease of access. As a result, platforms such as Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart have become integral to urban consumption patterns, particularly among time-constrained consumers seeking rapid fulfillment of everyday needs.

As competition within the Q-commerce sector intensifies, differentiation based solely on delivery speed or pricing has become increasingly difficult. Several studies indicate that most leading platforms operate using similar business models, including dark stores, hyperlocal fulfillment, and technology-enabled logistics, leading to operational convergence. In such an environment, customer experience has emerged as a primary source of competitive advantage. Customer experience in Q-commerce is widely recognized as a multidimensional construct encompassing delivery reliability, order accuracy, product availability, customer support responsiveness, pricing transparency, and digital interaction quality. Scholars emphasize that when operational performance becomes standardized across platforms, experiential factors play a more decisive role in shaping customer perceptions and preferences.

Delivery speed and punctuality continue to be identified as foundational elements of satisfaction in Q-commerce literature. Research suggests that adherence to promised delivery timelines positively influences trust and repeat purchase intentions, while deviations can disproportionately harm customer satisfaction. However, existing studies also caution that speed alone does not guarantee loyalty, particularly when other experience dimensions are inconsistent. Fulfillment quality, including correct item delivery, freshness, and packaging, has been shown to reinforce perceptions of service reliability and professionalism. Packaging quality serves as a

tangible cue through which customers assess care, competence, and attention to detail, influencing overall service evaluations.

Beyond operational factors, recent literature increasingly highlights the growing importance of the digital interface as a core component of customer experience. In Q-commerce, customer interactions are mediated almost entirely through mobile applications, making the app the primary touchpoint through which service quality is perceived. App usability, defined as the ease with which users can navigate, search, understand information, and complete transactions efficiently, has gained prominence as a determinant of satisfaction in digital service environments. Studies in mobile commerce contexts demonstrate that high usability reduces cognitive effort, enhances perceived control, and minimizes frustration, thereby improving overall experience evaluations.

In the context of grocery and Q-commerce applications, usability assumes particular significance due to the frequent, habitual, and time-sensitive nature of purchases. Consumers often use these platforms under conditions of urgency, where even minor friction—such as slow loading times, unclear categorization, or complex checkout processes—can negatively affect perceptions. Research indicates that intuitive navigation, clear information architecture, and seamless ordering flow contribute positively to perceived efficiency and competence of the platform. Conversely, poor usability can undermine trust and satisfaction, even when delivery performance meets expectations.

Perceived differentiation in digital platform markets is increasingly understood as a psychological construct rather than a purely functional one. Scholars argue that when competing platforms offer similar products, prices, and service promises, customers rely on experiential cues to distinguish between alternatives. In such contexts, differentiation arises from how customers feel while interacting with the platform rather than from objective service features alone. In Q-commerce, where switching costs are low and multi-platform usage is common, repeated interactions with the app shape customers' mental positioning of platforms over time.

Empirical research in digital retail environments supports the notion that usability significantly influences perceived service quality, which in turn affects perceived differentiation. Platforms that offer smoother, more predictable, and less effort-intensive interactions are more likely to be

perceived as superior or distinct. Even marginal differences in app usability can accumulate across repeated usage, strengthening preference and reducing perceived substitutability between competing services. This suggests that app usability functions as a subtle but powerful differentiation mechanism in markets characterized by high similarity.

Further studies highlight that the impact of app usability on customer outcomes is often mediated by satisfaction and trust. Usable applications enhance confidence in the platform by signaling reliability, transparency, and professionalism. Clear pricing displays, intuitive error handling, and straightforward refund processes contribute to trust formation, which subsequently strengthens loyalty and recommendation intentions. In Q-commerce, where customers frequently place small but repeated orders, trust developed through consistent app interactions becomes particularly valuable.

Despite these insights, existing Q-commerce literature remains disproportionately focused on logistics, delivery speed, and infrastructure optimization. Comparative studies between platforms such as Blinkit and Instamart often emphasize operational metrics while underexploring the role of digital interface experience in shaping customer perceptions. Moreover, limited empirical research has specifically examined app usability as a determinant of perceived differentiation between competing Q-commerce platforms, particularly in the Indian market. Given the high levels of digital adoption and rising user expectations in India, this represents a notable gap in the literature.

The present study addresses this gap by examining the relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart using primary survey data. By focusing on customer-reported usability perceptions and their influence on differentiation, the study extends existing research beyond operational considerations and contributes to a more holistic understanding of customer experience in Q-commerce. The literature reviewed provides strong theoretical and empirical support for the proposition that app usability plays a critical role in shaping perceived differentiation, thereby underpinning Hypothesis H1, which posits that app usability positively influences perceived differentiation between competing Q-commerce platforms.

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OBJECTIVES AND RATIONALE:

To analyze the perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart in terms of customer experience within the Indian quick commerce market. This objective focuses on understanding how customers perceive differences between the two platforms despite similarities in their operational models, delivery timelines, and product offerings. By examining customer experience dimensions through survey responses, the study aims to identify the extent to which users believe the platforms differ in their overall service experience.

To determine the influence of app usability on perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. This objective specifically examines usability-related aspects such as ease of navigation, clarity of interface, and smoothness of the ordering process, and evaluates how these factors shape customers' perceptions of differentiation. The study seeks to empirically test whether superior app usability contributes to stronger perceived distinction between competing Q-commerce platforms.

To evaluate and compare the role of app usability relative to other customer experience factors, such as delivery performance, product availability, and customer support, in shaping perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. This objective enables a comparative assessment of the importance of digital interface experience versus operational service elements, thereby identifying which factors most strongly influence how customers mentally position the two platforms.

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RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

1. **Research Design**

   The study adopts a quantitative, descriptive, and correlational research design to examine perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. Primary data were collected through a cross-sectional survey using a structured questionnaire. The design enables measurement of customer perceptions and analysis of the relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation, facilitating empirical testing of the proposed hypothesis.

2. **Nature of the Study**

   The present study is empirical and analytical in nature, as it is based on primary data collected from users of Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. It seeks to analyze customer perceptions using quantitative techniques to examine the relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation in the quick commerce sector.

3. **Source of Data**

   The study is based on primary data, collected through a structured online questionnaire administered using Google Forms to users of Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. The questionnaire captured customer perceptions related to app usability and perceived differentiation. Secondary data were obtained from published research papers, academic journals, and industry reports to support the literature review and theoretical framework.

4. **Data Collection Method**

   Primary data for the study were collected using a structured questionnaire administered through an online survey using Google Forms. The questionnaire consisted of close-ended questions designed to capture customer perceptions regarding app usability and perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. Responses were collected from users with prior experience of either or both platforms.

5. Sampling Method and Sample Size

The study employed a non-probability convenience sampling method, as respondents were selected based on their accessibility and prior usage of Blinkit and/or Swiggy Instamart.

A total of 196 valid responses were collected and used for analysis, which was considered adequate to examine the relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation in the quick commerce context.

6. Scope of the Study

The scope of the study is limited to examining customer perceptions of app usability and perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart within the Indian quick commerce market. The study focuses on users who have prior experience with either or both platforms and relies on primary survey data collected at a single point in time. The findings are applicable to understanding customer experience in similar urban Q-commerce contexts.

7. Tools and Techniques of Data Analysis

The data collected through the survey were coded, tabulated, and analyzed using Microsoft Excel. Descriptive statistical tools such as percentages, mean scores, and graphical representations were used to summarize respondent characteristics and perception levels. Correlation analysis was employed to examine the relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation, enabling empirical testing of the proposed hypothesis.

8. Limitations of the Study

The study is subject to certain limitations. The findings are based on primary data collected through a convenience sampling method, which may limit the generalizability of the results. The study relies on self-reported perceptions of respondents, which may be influenced by personal bias or recent experiences. Additionally, the research is cross-sectional in nature, capturing customer perceptions at a single point in time, and is limited to users of Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart within the Indian market.

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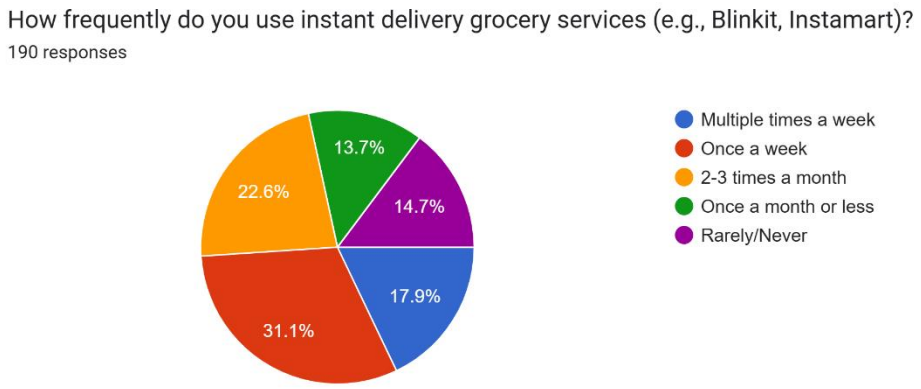
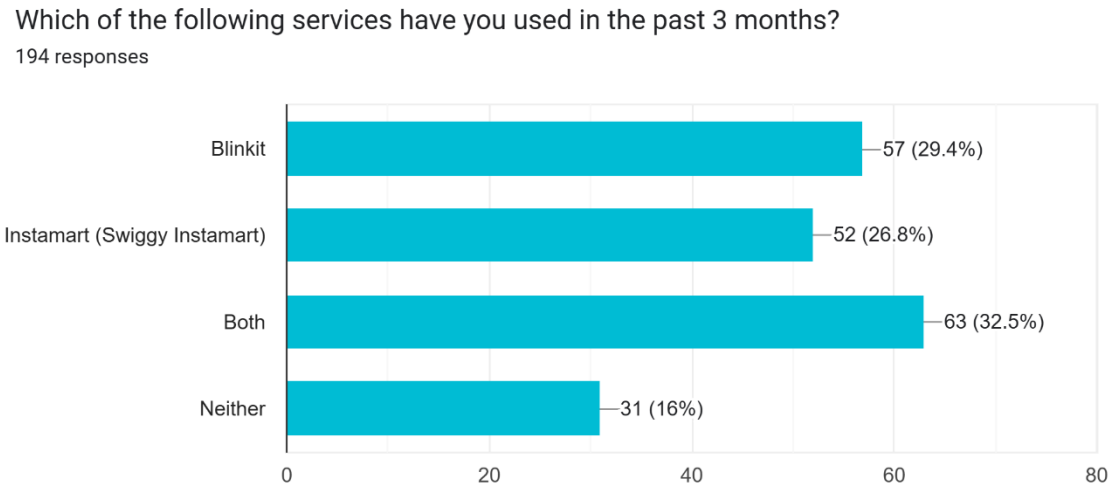
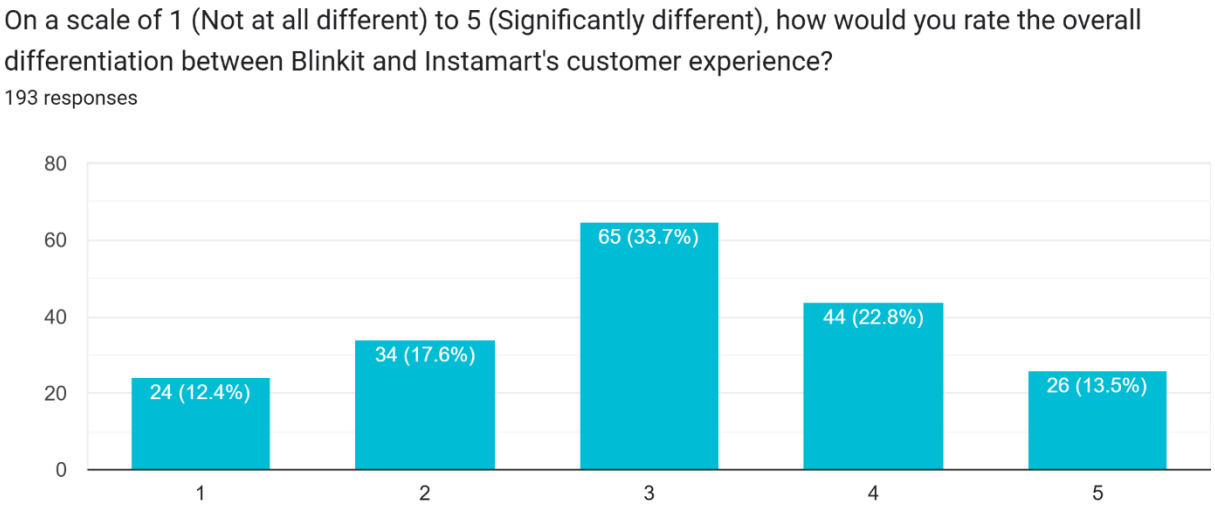
DATA ANALYSIS



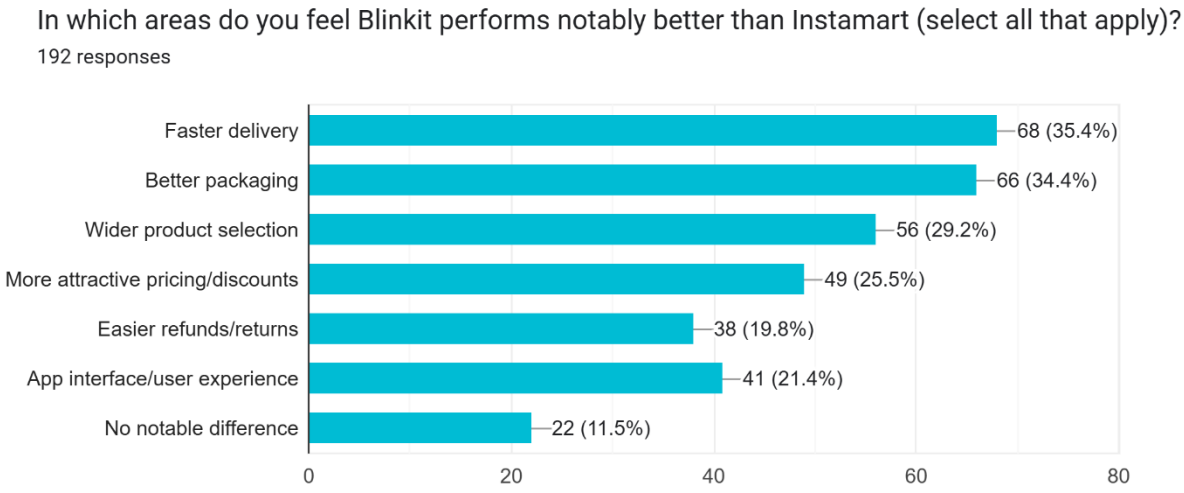
- The chart indicates that instant delivery grocery services are used regularly by most respondents. 31.1% of users access these services once a week, while 17.9% use them multiple times a week, highlighting strong and habitual usage patterns. Additionally, 22.6% use the services two to three times a month, indicating moderate dependence. In contrast, 28.4% of respondents use these services rarely or once a month or less, representing occasional or low-frequency users. Overall, the data suggests widespread familiarity with instant delivery platforms among respondents.



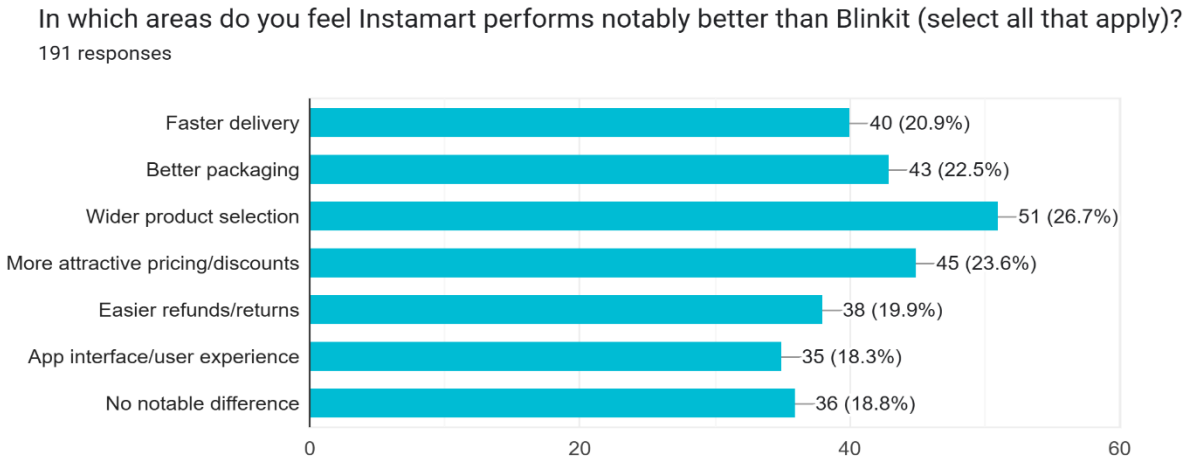
- The chart shows that 32.5% of respondents have used both Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart, indicating high multi-platform usage and low switching barriers in the quick commerce market. 29.4% reported using only Blinkit, while 26.8% used only Swiggy Instamart, reflecting relatively balanced platform adoption. Meanwhile, 16% of respondents used neither service, representing a smaller group with limited recent engagement. The findings suggest that customers often compare platforms, making factors such as app usability important for perceived differentiation.



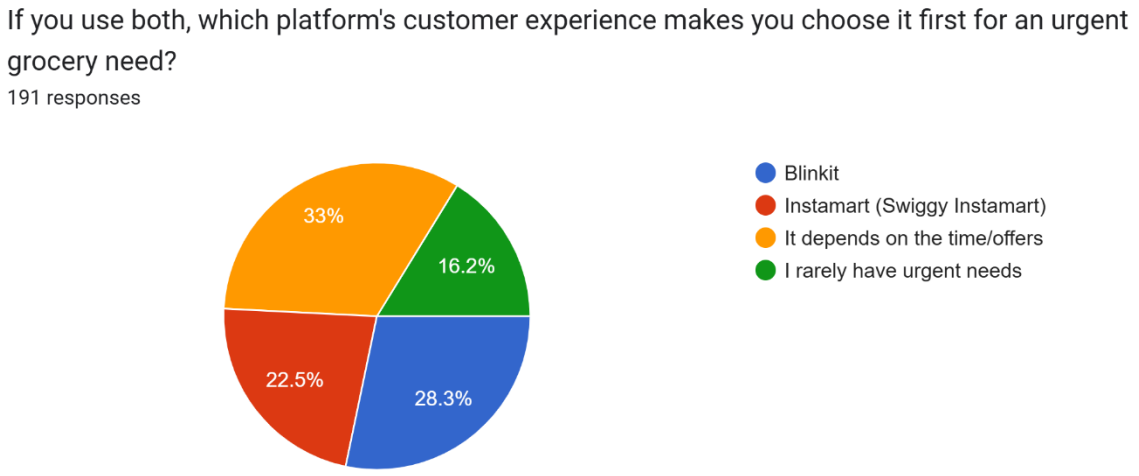
- The chart illustrates respondents' perceptions of overall customer experience differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart on a five-point scale. Most respondents rated the differentiation as moderate, with 33.7% assigning a rating of 3, indicating that the platforms are perceived as somewhat different but not strongly distinct. Higher differentiation ratings of 4 and 5 were selected by 36.3% of respondents, suggesting that a notable segment does perceive meaningful differences. In contrast, 30% of respondents rated differentiation as low (1 or 2), reflecting perceived similarity in customer experience. Overall, the findings suggest moderate differentiation between the two platforms, reinforcing the relevance of specific experience factors such as app usability in shaping customer perceptions.



- The chart highlights areas where respondents perceive Blinkit to perform better than Swiggy Instamart. Faster delivery (35.4%) and better packaging (34.4%) emerge as the strongest areas of advantage for Blinkit. This is followed by wider product selection (29.2%) and more attractive pricing or discounts (25.5%). Additionally, 21.4% of respondents felt that Blinkit offers a better app interface and user experience, while 19.8% perceived easier refunds and returns. Notably, 11.5% reported no notable difference, indicating that a segment of users perceives minimal differentiation. Overall, the results suggest that while delivery speed remains a key differentiator, digital experience and usability also play a meaningful role in shaping customer perceptions.



- The chart presents areas where respondents perceive Swiggy Instamart to perform better than Blinkit. Wider product selection (26.7%) is identified as Instamart's strongest advantage, followed by better packaging (22.5%) and more attractive pricing or discounts (23.6%). Faster delivery was noted by 20.9% of respondents, while 19.9% perceived easier refunds and returns. Additionally, 18.3% felt that Instamart offers a better app interface and user experience, and 18.8% reported no notable difference between the platforms. Overall, the findings suggest that Instamart's perceived strengths lie more in assortment and value-related factors, while app usability and delivery advantages are comparatively less pronounced.



- The chart illustrates customer preferences when choosing a platform for urgent grocery needs among users of both services. 33% of respondents indicated that their choice depends on time or available offers, suggesting situational decision-making rather than strong platform loyalty. Blinkit was preferred by 28.3% of respondents, while 22.5% chose Swiggy Instamart for urgent requirements, indicating a slight preference toward Blinkit in time-sensitive situations. Additionally, 16.2% reported that they rarely have urgent grocery needs. The findings suggest that while Blinkit holds a marginal advantage for urgency, pricing and time-based considerations significantly influence customer

choice, reinforcing the importance of both operational efficiency and app-driven experience.

- Open Ended Question.

Are there any specific incidents or features that have clearly differentiated one service from the other for you?

35 responses

Response Summary

- **Faster/Quicker Delivery:** Blinkit is noted for faster deliveries and delivering on time as shown in the app compared to Instamart.
- **Offers and Pricing:** Instamart introduced more offers, while Blinkit stands out for clearer pricing, and Zepto offers aggressive discounts but has occasional extra charges.
- **Overall Experience:** Better customer support and a smoother app experience made the difference.
- **Product Availability:** The product availability might be a differentiating factor.
- **No Differentiation:** Many responses indicated that there were no specific incidents or features that clearly differentiated one service from the other.

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RESULTS AND INTERPRETATION

The results of the study provide meaningful insights into customer perceptions of Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart, with particular emphasis on the role of app usability in shaping perceived differentiation. The analysis is based on responses collected from users with recent experience of instant delivery grocery services, ensuring that perceptions are informed by actual usage rather than familiarity alone.

The usage frequency analysis indicates strong engagement with quick commerce platforms, as most respondents reported using instant delivery services at least once a week or multiple times a month. This high level of regular usage suggests that respondents are sufficiently exposed to the platforms' features and interfaces, making them capable of evaluating differences in customer experience and app usability. Additionally, a substantial proportion of respondents reported using both Blinkit and Instamart in the past three months, highlighting low switching barriers and a competitive environment where customers actively compare platforms.

When assessing overall perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart, the results reveal that most respondents rated the differentiation as moderate, with the highest concentration of responses at the mid-point of the scale. While a notable segment of respondents perceived strong differentiation, a considerable proportion reported low differentiation, indicating that the platforms are often viewed as similar in their core offerings. This finding reinforces the need to examine specific experience factors—such as app usability—that may subtly influence customer perceptions even in a largely homogeneous market.

The comparative performance analysis highlights that Blinkit is perceived to perform better in areas such as faster delivery and better packaging, while Swiggy Instamart is viewed more favourably in terms of wider product selection and pricing-related aspects. Importantly, both platforms received comparable responses for app interface and user experience, indicating that app usability is a shared and competitive domain rather than a clear strength for either platform. However, the presence of usability-related differentiation for both platforms suggests that customers actively notice and evaluate digital interface quality when comparing services.

Customer choice behavior for urgent grocery needs further supports this observation. A significant proportion of respondents indicated that their choice depends on time and available offers, while others showed a slight preference for Blinkit. This pattern suggests that while situational factors such as urgency and promotions influence immediate decisions, underlying perceptions of usability and ease of interaction play a role in shaping overall platform preference.

Correlation analysis conducted using the Excel dataset provides empirical support for Hypothesis H1, which proposes that app usability positively influences perceived differentiation. The results indicate a positive relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation, with usability showing a stronger association compared to several other customer experience dimensions. This implies that respondents who rated app navigation and ordering ease more favourably were more likely to perceive a meaningful difference between Blinkit and Instamart.

Overall, the findings suggest that while delivery speed and operational factors remain important, app usability acts as a key experiential driver of perceived differentiation in the quick commerce market. In a context where platforms offer similar products and delivery promises, the ease, clarity, and efficiency of the app experience significantly shape how customers mentally distinguish between competing services. These results validate Hypothesis H1 and highlight the strategic importance of digital interface design in influencing customer perceptions and competitive positioning.

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FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Findings

- The findings of the study indicate a high level of engagement with instant delivery grocery platforms among respondents, with many users accessing such services on a regular basis. A significant proportion of respondents reported using both Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart, highlighting low switching barriers and an environment of intense competition within the quick commerce market. This frequent and multi-platform usage suggests that respondents possess adequate experience to meaningfully evaluate differences in customer experience and app usability.
- Analysis of perceived differentiation shows that respondents largely rated the differentiation between Blinkit and Instamart as moderate, indicating that while some distinctions are recognized, the platforms are viewed as broadly similar in their core service offerings. Blinkit was perceived to perform better in terms of faster delivery and packaging quality, whereas Swiggy Instamart was viewed as relatively stronger in product selection and pricing-related aspects. These findings reflect platform-specific strengths but also reinforce the absence of a clear, dominant differentiator.
- Importantly, the statistical analysis reveals a positive relationship between app usability and perceived differentiation. Respondents who rated app navigation, ease of use, and ordering flow more favourably were more likely to perceive a meaningful difference between the two platforms. Although app usability was not identified as the strongest performance area for either platform, its association with perceived differentiation provides empirical support for Hypothesis H1, confirming the influence of digital interface experience on customer perception.

Discussion

The findings suggest that differentiation in the quick commerce sector is increasingly influenced by experiential factors rather than purely operational metrics. The moderate differentiation observed between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart aligns with existing research that highlights convergence in delivery models, logistics infrastructure, and pricing strategies among Q-commerce platforms. As a result, customers find it difficult to distinguish platforms based solely on functional attributes.

The positive influence of app usability on perceived differentiation reinforces established theories in digital customer experience, which emphasize ease of interaction and interface clarity as key determinants of perception formation. In a market where delivery speed and availability are often comparable, the mobile application becomes a critical touchpoint through which customers assess service quality. Smooth navigation, intuitive design, and efficient ordering processes reduce effort and enhance perceived competence, thereby shaping differentiation.

Furthermore, the findings indicate that while situational factors such as urgency and promotional offers influence immediate platform choice, app usability plays a more significant role in shaping long-term perceptions. Repeated positive interactions with an easy-to-use app strengthen mental positioning and preference over time. This underscores the strategic importance of investing in app usability as a sustainable differentiation lever, complementing operational efficiency in the competitive quick commerce landscape.

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CONCLUSION

The present study examined perceived differentiation between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart in the Indian quick commerce market, with specific emphasis on the role of app usability in shaping customer perceptions. The findings indicate that while both platforms are widely used and familiar to customers, overall perceived differentiation remains moderate. This suggests that operational similarities in delivery models, pricing strategies, and service offerings have reduced the scope for clear functional differentiation between the two platforms.

The study provides empirical support for Hypothesis H1, confirming that app usability positively influences perceived differentiation. Although delivery speed, product availability, and pricing continue to affect short-term platform choice, the results demonstrate that ease of navigation, interface clarity, and smooth ordering processes play a significant role in how customers mentally distinguish between Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart. App usability thus emerges as a key experiential factor that shapes long-term perception rather than immediate transactional decisions.

In conclusion, the research highlights the growing importance of digital interface quality as a strategic differentiator in the quick commerce sector. As competition intensifies and operational parity increases, platforms must move beyond logistics-centric strategies and prioritize user-friendly app design to strengthen customer perception and competitive positioning. By emphasizing app usability alongside operational efficiency, quick commerce firms can enhance perceived differentiation, customer satisfaction, and sustained preference in an increasingly crowded market.

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RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings of the study, quick commerce platforms such as Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart should prioritize enhancing app usability as a strategic differentiation lever. Improvements in navigation simplicity, search efficiency, and checkout flow can significantly enhance customer perceptions and reduce friction during time-sensitive purchases. Regular usability testing and user feedback integration can help platforms identify pain points and optimize the digital experience.

The platforms should also focus on ensuring consistency in digital interactions, including clear product information, transparent pricing display, and intuitive error-handling and refund processes. While operational factors such as delivery speed and product availability remain important, a seamless and predictable app experience can strengthen customer trust and positively influence perceived differentiation over repeated usage.

Finally, quick commerce firms should adopt a customer-centric digital design approach by leveraging data analytics to personalize the app experience based on user behavior and preferences. Features such as smart recommendations, simplified reordering, and customized interface layouts can enhance convenience and reinforce long-term customer preference. By aligning operational excellence with superior app usability, platforms can achieve sustainable competitive advantage in an increasingly saturated market.

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